

I'm not sure who decided that if a white male does something, it must automatically be more complex compared with the jobs that women traditionally do.

I think part of the issue is that representation does, in fact, matter. Famous female investors are few and far between: Sallie Krawcheck, hailed as 'one of the last honest brokers', is one of the few investors who made it to the front page of the *Wall Street Journal*, and even then she was only there because of her public firing.

The investing industry did a really great job at perpetuating this myth for as long as they possibly could. After all, fund managers make a lot of money when someone thinks it's all too complicated and would rather pay the fund manager a cut of their entire investing portfolio. Gatekeeping investing keeps certain people in business.

Now, I do want to note that there is a time and place for professionals in all areas. In some circumstances, it makes sense to hire a fund manager to invest for you, for example, if you inherit a large sum of money after a death in the family and aren't emotionally in the right frame of mind to invest yourself, or if you would like a hand to hold during the ups and downs of the market. Sometimes people with ADHD or other neurodivergent tendencies would benefit from having an adviser who provides assistance as required. There is no one right or wrong way to invest, but this book will teach you how to determine the best way for you.

You don't need a degree in finance to invest for yourself. The skills needed to invest are so simple once they are broken down. To this day, I've never met a person who couldn't understand how to invest in the stock market once it was explained in a way that made sense to them. The Friends That Invest community is made up of women, men and nonbinary folk whose education levels range from those who didn't complete high school, to those with doctorate degrees. We even have people telling us that their bachelor's degree in economics or accounting hadn't even explained investing clearly. Due to their lecturers knowing the subject so well, it was almost difficult for them to articulate it in a way a beginner could grasp.

Let me set the record straight, investing does not involve many graphs and hours of following trends. It doesn't involve large risks and calculations. To